



BRIEFING PAPER

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Local Elections 2017

By Noel Dempsey

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Summary

Elections were held for 4,846 seats on 88 local councils in England, Scotland and Wales on 4 May 2017. These elections comprised:

- 1,787 seats on 27 County Councils in England
- 527 seats on 6 Unitary Authorities in England
- 55 seats on 1 Metropolitan Borough in England
- 1,277 seats on 32 Scottish local authorities
- 1,250 seats on 22 Welsh local authorities

In England the **Conservatives** won 61% of seats up for election, this is nearly double the percentage of available seats won in 2016 (31%). **Labour** won 18% of seats up for election (this is less than half the share of available seats won in 2016, 47%). The **Liberal Democrats** won 13% of available seats, a slight fall on the share received in 2016 (14%).

In Scotland the **SNP** won 35% of seats, the same share as in 2012. In Wales **Plaid Cymru** won 16% of seats, an increase of 2% points on 2012.

The 2017 local elections took place with a “snap” General Election being announced two weeks earlier on 18 April.

1. Results summary

In England the **Conservatives** won or retained 27 of the councils which had elections on 4 May 2017, and now control a total of 200 councils overall.

The majority of the gains made by the Conservatives in England were from councils which had no overall control, although the Conservatives did gain Derbyshire county council from Labour.

In Scotland the Conservatives did not make any gains and still do not control any councils. In Wales the Conservatives gained Monmouthshire from no overall control and now control a total of one council.

In England the **Labour** party retained control of two of the councils which had elections on 4 May 2017 (County Durham and Doncaster) and now control 99 councils in total. Labour had two losses (Derbyshire and Nottinghamshire).

In Scotland Labour lost all four councils they previously controlled to no overall control, although all of these councils (as with many others in Scotland) have recently had boundary changes.

Labour retained seven councils in Wales but lost three councils to no overall control and “other” parties/candidates.

In England the **Liberal Democrats** did not win control of any of the county councils which had elections on 4 May 2017. The Liberal Democrats now control a total of 8 councils.

In both Scotland and Wales the Liberal Democrats did not win control of any council.

In England **UKIP** did not gain control of any council which had elections on 4 May 2017. At the previous county council elections in England UKIP won 149 seats, at the 4 May 2017 round of elections UKIP won one seat.

In Scotland the **SNP** lost control of two councils to no overall control (Angus and Dundee City). In Scotland the SNP currently do not control any council. The SNP increased the total number of councillors by 7 to 431 compared to the previous round of elections.

In Wales **Plaid Cymru** gained control of one council from no overall control (Gwynedd). In total Plaid Cymru control a total of one council in Wales. Plaid Cymru increased the total number of councillors by 33 to 203 compared to the previous round of elections.

For more information on the difference between the BBC and House of Commons Library analyses, see section 9, ‘About the data’.

2. Elections in England

Local councils in England

All areas of England are covered either by a unitary council, a metropolitan borough council, a London borough council or a county council.

Unitary, metropolitan and London borough councils are all 'single-tier' councils.

In most cases county councils and district councils comprise a 'two-tier' system, with upper-tier county councils covering multiple lower-tier district councils.

Electoral cycles

Local council members are elected for 4 year terms using the first past the post system.

There are a variety of electoral cycles (elections are held in different years) so not all councillors are elected (at the same time). In some authorities (including London boroughs and all county councils) elections are held every four years. Others elect a proportion of members in each year.

There are three methods of holding elections to local councils: whole council; thirds; and halves.

- **Whole:** All councillors are elected once every four years, in whole council elections.
- **Thirds:** Councillors are elected for four-year terms by thirds; that is, at each election, a third of the councillors are elected. Elections are held every year except in years when there are county council elections in the rest of England.
- **Halves:** Councillors are elected for four-year terms by halves; that is, at each election, half the councillors are elected. Elections are held every two years.

Council election cycles in England 2007 to 2017: a rough guide

	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Unitary Councils											
Metropolitan											
London Boroughs											
District Councils											
County Councils											

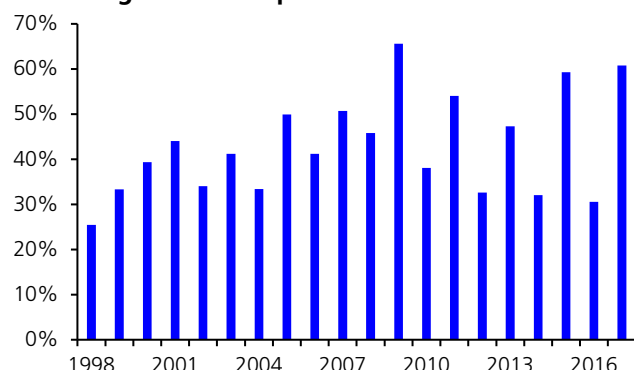
Note: Shaded years indicate elections held. In most cases County Councils, for example, elect on a rolling four year cycle - subject to change should by-elections or boundary changes occur.

All councils (even those that use a different method for holding elections) hold elections for the entire council following local government boundary reviews. By-elections may also take place in a local authority should a council seat become vacant during a councillor's term.

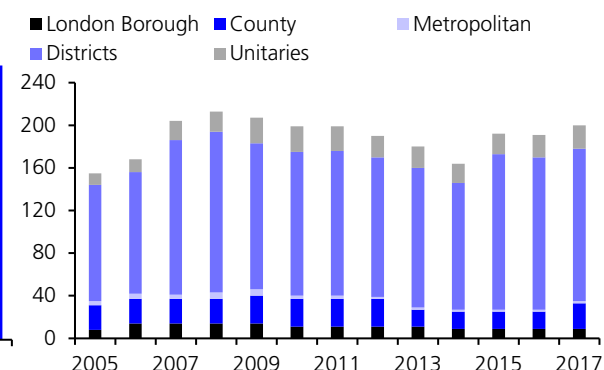
Conservative

- The Conservatives won 61% of seats up for election on 4 May 2017 in England.
- This is just under double the percentage of available seats received in 2016 (31%).
- The number of councils controlled increased by 9 to 200. This the largest number of control councils since since 2010.

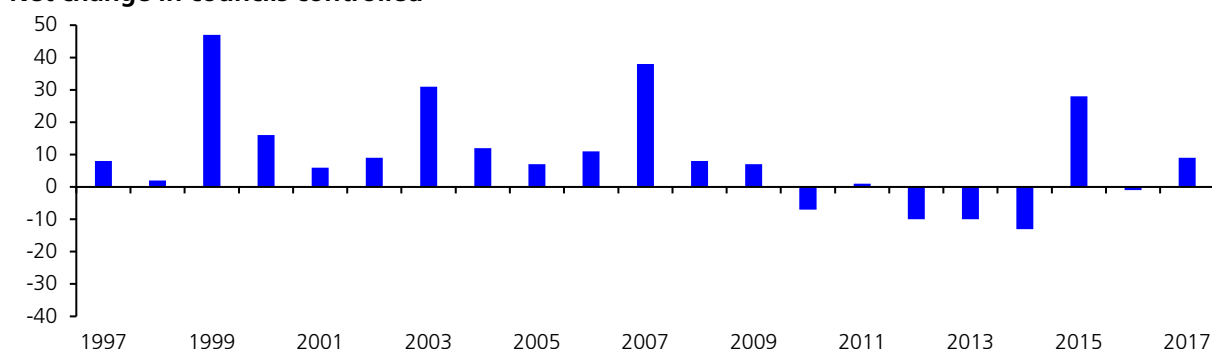
Percentage of seats up for election won ^a



Councils controlled ^b



Net change in councils controlled ^c



Summary

	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Seats won	1,300	1,520	1,609	5,113	786	1,117	1,366	5,540	851	1,440
Unitary Councils	289	259	120	851	105	183	115	941	138	231
Metropolitan	247		154	151	110		128	162	114	7
London Boroughs			717				612			
District Councils	764		618	4,111	571		511	4,437	599	
County Councils		1,261				934				1,202
% of seats up for election won ^a	46%	66%	38%	54%	33%	47%	32%	59%	31%	61%
Council control ^b	213	207	199	199	190	180	164	192	191	200
Unitary Councils	19	24	24	23	20	20	18	19	21	22
Metropolitan	6	6	3	3	2	2	2	2	2	2
London Boroughs	14	14	11	11	11	11	9	9	9	9
District Councils	151	137	135	136	131	131	119	146	143	143
County Councils	23	26	26	26	26	16	16	16	16	24
Net change in council control ^c	8	7	-7	1	-10	-10	-13	28	-1	9

A - All figures England only. Shows seats won by stated party as a percentage of total seats up for election. Note not all parties field candidates in all seats.

B - Council control immediately following elections of stated year

C - Net change compared to control immediately prior to election; figures not comparable with year-on-year changes to total number of councils controlled by party

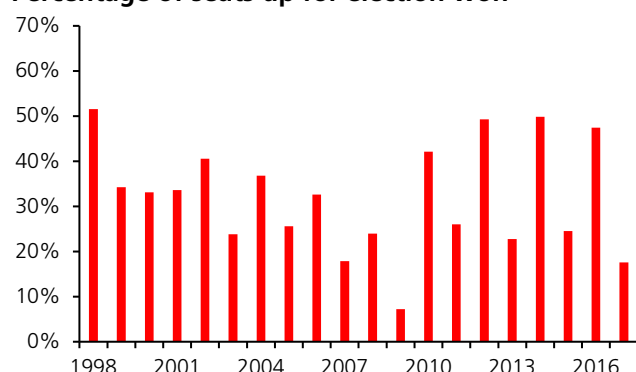
D - Figures for councils controlled and net change in councils controlled refer to those controlled by an absolute majority; minority controlled councils are excluded

Sources: 1997 - 2016 data from Rallings & Thrasher Local Elections Handbooks; 2017 data collated by House of Commons Library; Rallings and Thrasher; "Rallings and Thrasher: local elections have brought a profound change in party fortunes" (Local Government Chronicle); 9 May 2017.

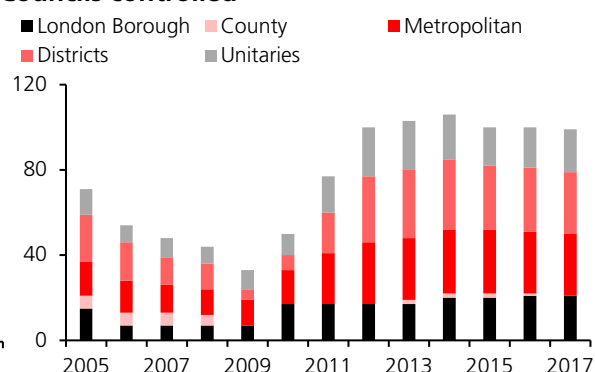
Labour

- Labour won 18% of the seats up for election on 4 May 2017 in England.
- This is under half the percentage of available seats received in 2016 (47%). This is the lowest percentage since 2013.
- The number of councils Labour controlled reduced by 1 compared to 2015 (100). This continues a period of stability since 2012 with the number remaining around 100 after dropping to 33 in 2009.

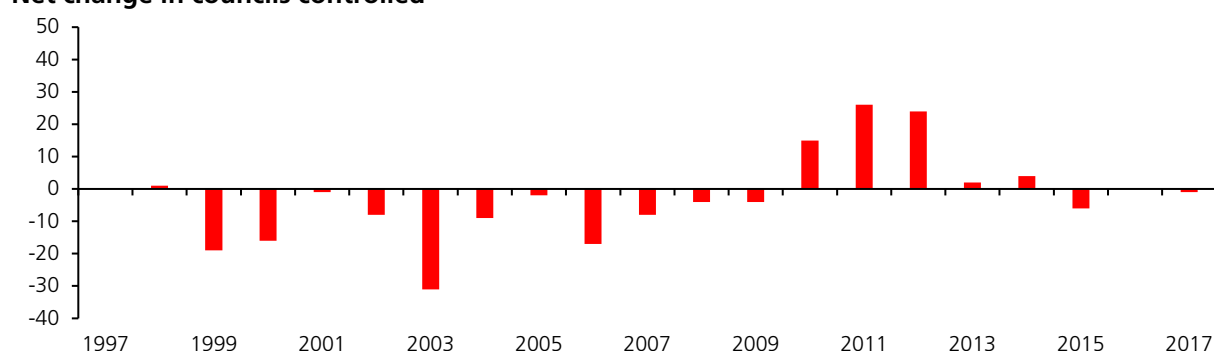
Percentage of seats up for election won ^a



Councils controlled ^b



Net change in councils controlled ^c



Summary

	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Seats won	680	167	1,778	2,461	1,189	538	2,124	2,292	1,319	417
Unitary Councils	190	19	153	707	203	158	191	673	233	115
Metropolitan	317		521	594	604		565	634	664	43
London Boroughs			875				1,060			
District Councils	173		229	1,160	382		308	985	422	
County Councils		148				380				259
% of seats up for election won ^a	24%	7%	42%	26%	49%	23%	50%	25%	47%	18%
Council control ^b	44	33	50	77	100	103	106	100	100	99
Unitary Councils	8	9	10	17	23	23	21	18	19	20
Metropolitan	12	12	16	24	29	29	30	30	29	29
London Boroughs	7	7	17	17	17	17	20	20	21	21
District Councils	12	5	7	19	31	32	33	30	30	29
County Councils	5	0	0	0	0	2	2	2	1	0
Net change in council control ^c	-4	-4	15	26	24	2	4	-6	0	-1

A - All figures England only. Shows seats won by stated party as a percentage of total seats up for election. Note not all parties field candidates in all seats.

B - Council control immediately following elections of stated year

C - Net change compared to control immediately prior to election; figures not comparable with year-on-year changes to total number of councils controlled by party

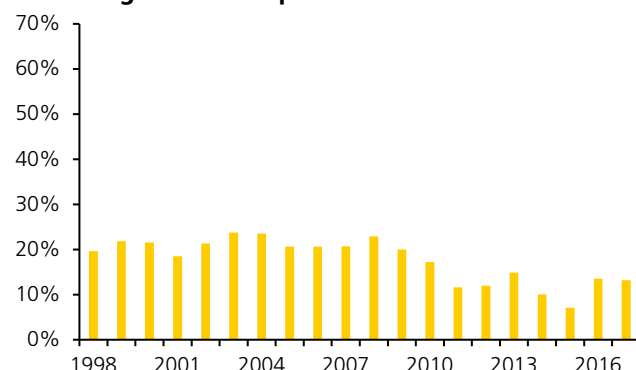
D - Figures for councils controlled and net change in councils controlled refer to those controlled by an absolute majority; minority controlled councils are excluded

Sources: 1997 - 2016 data from Rallings & Thrasher Local Elections Handbooks; 2017 data collated by House of Commons Library; Rallings and Thrasher; "Rallings and Thrasher: local elections have brought a profound change in party fortunes" (Local Government Chronicle); 9 May 2017.

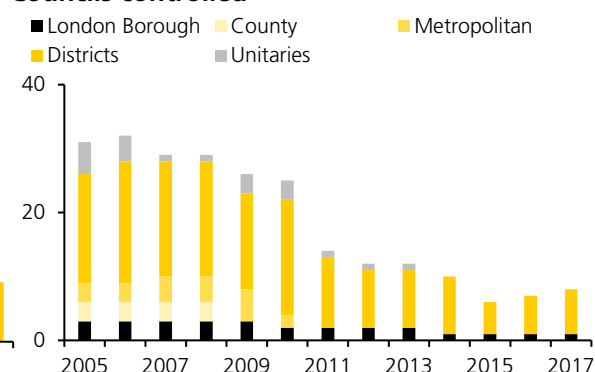
Liberal Democrats

- The Liberal Democrats won 13% of the seats up for election on 4 May 2017 in England.
- This is slightly lower than in 2016 where they won 14% of seats and 2% less than the comparable elections in 2013.
- The gain of 1 council for the Liberal Democrats is the second consecutive gain since 2012. The highest number of Liberal Democrat controlled councils during the last decade was in 2006 (32).

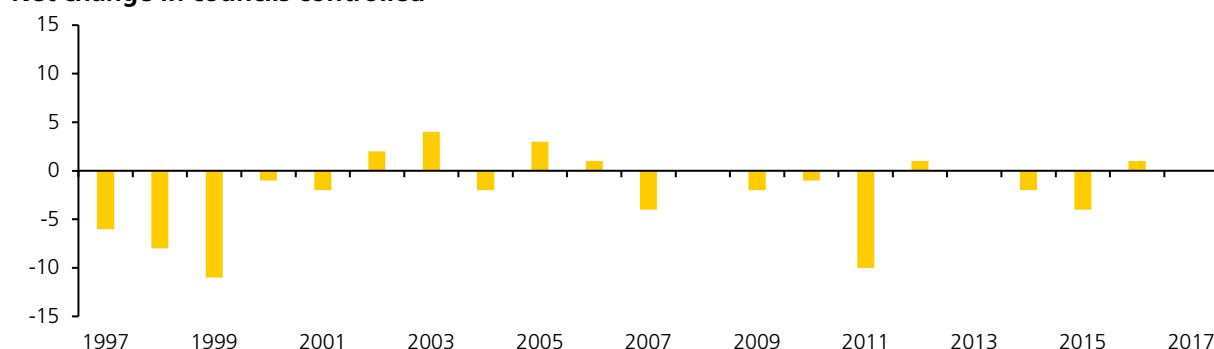
Percentage of seats up for election won ^a



Councils controlled ^b



Net change in councils controlled ^c



Summary

	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Seats won	651	463	728	1,099	288	352	429	661	377	313
Unitary Councils	142	117	75	216	40	101	45	123	54	88
Metropolitan	208		133	56	72		66	40	88	-
London Boroughs			246				116			
District Councils	301		274	827	176		202	498	235	
County Councils		346				251				225
% of seats up for election won ^a	23%	20%	17%	12%	12%	15%	10%	7%	14%	13%
Council control ^b	29	26	25	14	12	12	10	6	7	8
Unitary Councils	1	3	3	1	1	1	0	0	0	0
Metropolitan	4	5	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
London Boroughs	3	3	2	2	2	2	1	1	1	1
District Councils	18	15	18	11	9	9	9	5	6	7
County Councils	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Net change in council control ^c	0	-2	-1	-10	1	0	-2	-4	1	0

A - All figures England only. Shows seats won by stated party as a percentage of total seats up for election. Note not all parties field candidates in all seats.

B - Council control immediately following elections of stated year

C - Net change compared to control immediately prior to election; figures not comparable with year-on-year changes to total number of councils controlled by party

D - Figures for councils controlled and net change in councils controlled refer to those controlled by an absolute majority; minority controlled councils are excluded

Sources: 1997 - 2016 data from Rallings & Thrasher Local Elections Handbooks; 2017 data collated by House of Commons Library; Rallings and Thrasher; "Rallings and Thrasher: local elections have brought a profound change in party fortunes" (Local Government Chronicle); 9 May 2017.

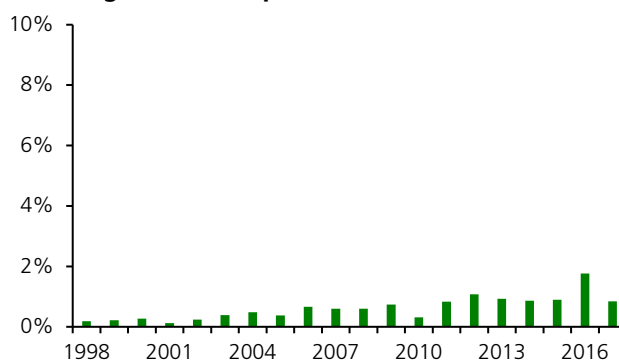
Green

- The Green Party won 1% of seats up for election in 2017 (20 seats) in England

- This a slight reduction on the share of seats won in 2016 and continues the trend in the relatively small proportion of seats the party has won

- The highest number of seats came in 2015 (84), followed by comparable elections in 2011 (79) and 2007 (63). The number of seats won in 2017 is the lowest number since 2013.

Percentage of seats up for election won ^a



Summary

	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Seats won	17	17	13	79	26	22	37	84	49	20
Unitary Councils	-	-	2	30	1	3	5	30	15	2
Metropolitan	6		2	8	10		12	7	12	-
London Boroughs			2				4			
District Councils	11		7	41	15		16	47	22	
County Councils		17				19				18
% of seats up for election won ^a	1%	1%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	1%

Note: The Green Party held minority control in Brighton between 2011 and 2015 as the largest party but did not hold a majority.

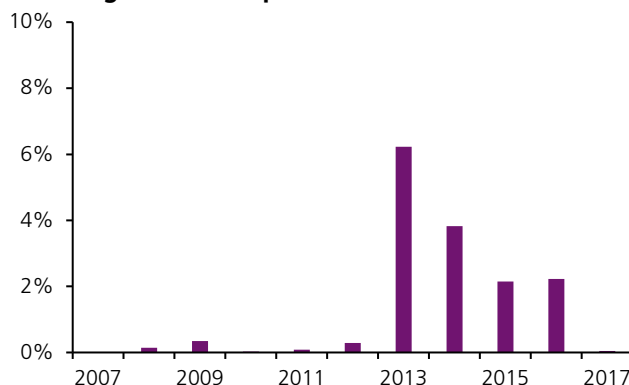
United Kingdom Independence Party

- The UK Independence Party (UKIP) won just one of the seats up for election in English County Councils in 2017. In 2013 UKIP won 138 seats on English County Councils.

- This was the smallest number of available seats since 2010 and reduction of 200 compared to 2015.

- The highest percentage of seats up for election won by UKIP was in 2013 (6%).

Percentage of seats up for election won ^a



Summary ^b

	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Seats won	4	8	1	8	7	147	163	201	62	1
Unitary Councils	1	-	-	1	2	9	37	23	15	-
Metropolitan	1		-	-	-		34	8	21	-
London Boroughs			-				12			
District Councils	2		1	7	5		80	170	26	
County Councils		8				138				1
% of seats up for election won ^a	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	6%	4%	2%	2%	0%

Note: UKIP took control of Thanet council in May 2015 but it returned to NOC in October 2015 following defections.

A - All figures England only. Shows seats won by stated party as a percentage of total seats up for election. Note not all parties field candidates in all seats.

B - Data available for UKIP from Rallings and Thrasher for 2008 onwards

Sources: 1997 - 2016 data from Rallings & Thrasher Local Elections Handbooks; 2016 data collated by House of Commons Library

4. Elections in Scotland

In Scotland local council elections are conducted using the Single Transferable Vote (STV), not the first-past-the-post basis as in England and Wales.

The following table summarises the results of the council elections in Scotland for the past five elections. The composition and control shown for local authorities is immediately following the local elections.

Scottish Local Election Results

	Number					Percentage				
	1999	2004	2007	2012	2017	1999	2004	2007	2012	2017
Seats										
CON	108	123	143	115	276	9%	10%	12%	9%	22%
LAB	550	509	348	394	261	45%	42%	28%	32%	21%
LD	156	175	166	71	67	13%	14%	14%	6%	5%
SNP	204	181	363	424	431	17%	15%	30%	35%	35%
Others	204	234	202	219	192	17%	19%	17%	18%	16%
Total	1,222	1,222	1,222	1,223	1,227	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Council control										
CON	0	0	0	0	0	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
LAB	15	13	2	4	0	47%	41%	6%	13%	0%
LD	0	1	0	0	0	0%	3%	0%	0%	0%
SNP	1	1	0	2	0	3%	3%	0%	6%	0%
Others	6	6	3	3	3	19%	19%	9%	9%	9%
NOC	10	11	27	23	29	31%	34%	84%	72%	91%
Total	32	32	32	32	32	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Source: Rallings and Thrasher Local Election Handbooks, various years; data collected by the House of Commons Library

In Scotland the SNP lost control of two councils to no overall control (Angus and Dundee City). The SNP currently do not control any council. The SNP increased the total number of councillors by 7 to 431 compared to the previous round of elections (the highest number of councillors in the last five years).

The Conservatives have the second highest number of councillors in Scotland (276), an increase of 161 on the elections in 2012.

Labour had the third highest number of councillors in Scotland (261), although this is a decrease of 133 compared to 2012.

The majority of councils in Scotland have no overall control (29).

5. Elections in Wales

The following table summarises the results of the council elections in Wales for the past five elections. The composition and control shown for local authorities is immediately following the local elections.

Welsh Local Election Results

	Number					Percentage				
	1999	2004	2008	2012	2017	1999	2004	2008	2012	2017
Seats										
CON	75	107	174	105	184	6%	8%	14%	8%	15%
LAB	563	479	345	579	472	44%	38%	27%	46%	38%
LD	98	146	165	73	62	8%	12%	13%	6%	5%
PC	205	175	206	170	203	16%	14%	16%	14%	16%
Others	329	356	374	327	329	26%	28%	30%	26%	26%
Total	1,270	1,263	1,264	1,254	1,250	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Council control										
CON	0	1	2	0	1	0%	5%	9%	0%	5%
LAB	8	8	2	10	7	36%	36%	9%	45%	32%
LD	0	0	0	0	0	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
PC	3	1	0	0	1	14%	5%	0%	0%	5%
Others	3	3	5	2	3	14%	14%	23%	9%	14%
NOC	8	9	13	10	10	36%	41%	59%	45%	45%
Total	22	22	22	22	22	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: 2012 includes the Isle of Anglesey election of 2013

Source: Rallings and Thrasher Local Election Handbooks, various years; data collected by the House of Commons Library

In Wales Plaid Cymru gained control of one council from no overall control (Gwynedd). In total Plaid Cymru control a total of one council in Wales. Plaid Cymru increased the total number of councillors by 33 to 203 compared to the previous round of elections in 2012.

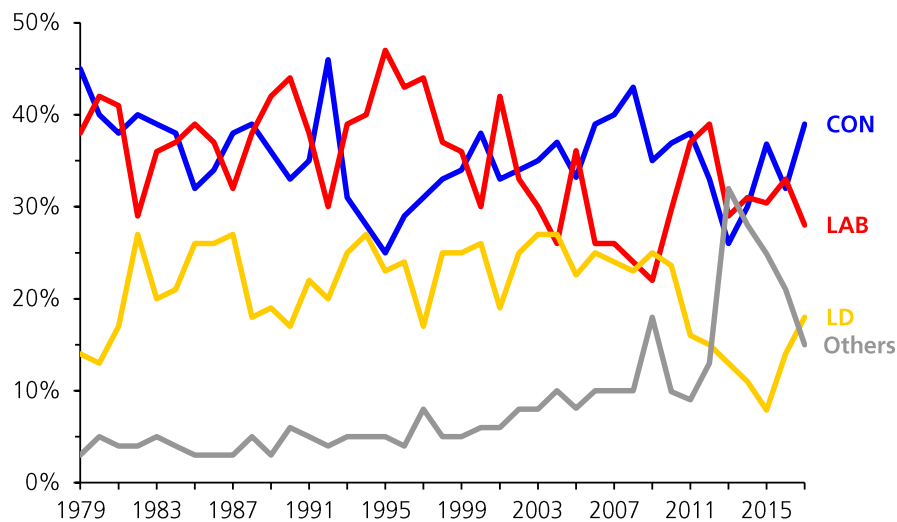
Labour had the highest number of councillors in Wales (472), although this is a decrease of 107 on the elections in 2012. In 2017 Labour won 38% of the council seats in Wales. Labour controls 7 councils in Wales, 3 fewer than in 2012.

The Conservatives had the fourth highest number of councillors (184), 79 more than in 2012. The Conservatives control 1 council in Wales.

6. National share of the vote

Because local elections are not held in all local authorities at the same time, it is difficult to get an overview of how much support political parties attract across Great Britain in the years between general elections. Academics Colin Rallings and Michael Thrasher (University of Plymouth) overcome this problem by using the results of local elections to estimate how the major parties would have fared had the elections of that year taken place throughout Great Britain. Rallings and Thrasher's National Equivalent share of the vote (NEV) is a widely used estimate of where the parties stand in the years where local elections have taken place.

Estimated NEV at local elections (Great Britain)



Labour's NEV in 2017 reduced by 5% points to 28% compared with 2016. The **Conservatives** increased their NEV by 7% points on 2016 to 39%.

The **Liberal Democrats** continued to increase their NEV. In 2017 the Liberal Democrats NEV was 18% (4% points higher than in 2016).

The 'others' category continued to decline in 2017 to 15% (6% points lower than in 2016). Included in this category, **UKIP's** NEV fell to 4% in 2017 (8% points lower than in 2016).

Estimated NEV at local elections (Great Britain)

	CON	LAB	LD	Others	of which UKIP
1979	45%	38%	14%	3%	
1980	40%	42%	13%	5%	
1981	38%	41%	17%	4%	
1982	40%	29%	27%	4%	
1983	39%	36%	20%	5%	
1984	38%	37%	21%	4%	
1985	32%	39%	26%	3%	
1986	34%	37%	26%	3%	
1987	38%	32%	27%	3%	
1988	39%	38%	18%	5%	
1989	36%	42%	19%	3%	
1990	33%	44%	17%	6%	
1991	35%	38%	22%	5%	
1992	46%	30%	20%	4%	
1993	31%	39%	25%	5%	
1994	28%	40%	27%	5%	
1995	25%	47%	23%	5%	
1996	29%	43%	24%	4%	
1997	31%	44%	17%	8%	
1998	33%	37%	25%	5%	
1999	34%	36%	25%	5%	
2000	38%	30%	26%	6%	
2001	33%	42%	19%	6%	
2002	34%	33%	25%	8%	
2003	35%	30%	27%	8%	
2004	37%	26%	27%	10%	
2005	33%	36%	23%	8%	
2006	39%	26%	25%	10%	
2007	40%	26%	24%	10%	
2008	43%	24%	23%	10%	
2009	35%	22%	25%	18%	
2010	37%	30%	24%	10%	
2011	38%	37%	16%	9%	
2012	33%	39%	15%	13%	
2013	26%	29%	13%	32%	22%
2014	30%	31%	11%	28%	18%
2015	37%	30%	8%	25%	13%
2016	32%	33%	14%	21%	12%
2017	39%	28%	18%	15%	4%

Note: Local elections in 1979, 1997, 2001, 2005, 2010 and 2015 were held on the same day as a general election, and in these years general election vote shares are shown in bold.

UKIP vote share calculated from 2013.

Source: Rallings and Thrasher, British Electoral Facts 1832-2006; Rallings and Thrasher, Local Elections Handbook, various years; Rallings and Thrasher, "Theresa still has a hill to climb before a landslide is triggered", The Sunday Times, May 7 2017.

7. Post-election composition

The table below summarises council composition and control for all local authorities in **England** immediately following the local elections held on 4 May 2017. This also includes those where elections were not held.

Post-election council composition and control: England

May 2017

	Number					Total	Percentage				
	CON	LAB	LD	OTH	NOC		CON	LAB	LD	OTH	NOC
Councillors											
London boroughs	608	1,055	113	75		1,851	33%	57%	6%	4%	
Metropolitan boroughs	392	1,714	182	131		2,419	16%	71%	8%	5%	
Counties	1,201	259	229	98		1,787	67%	14%	13%	5%	
Unitary authorities	1,360	1,103	299	339		3,101	44%	36%	10%	11%	
Shire districts	5,212	1,573	851	934		8,570	61%	18%	10%	11%	
England	8,773	5,704	1,674	1,577		17,728	49%	32%	9%	9%	
Councils controlled											
London boroughs	9	21	1	0	1	32	28%	66%	3%	0%	3%
Metropolitan boroughs	2	29	0	0	5	36	6%	81%	0%	0%	14%
County councils	24	0	0	0	3	27	89%	0%	0%	0%	11%
Unitary authorities	22	20	0	0	13	55	40%	36%	0%	0%	24%
Shire districts	143	29	7	2	20	201	71%	14%	3%	1%	10%
England	200	99	8	2	42	351	57%	28%	2%	1%	12%

Source: Rallings and Thrasher; "Rallings and Thrasher: local elections have brought a profound change in party fortunes" (Local Government Chronicle); 9 May 2017

The Conservatives hold the greatest share of seats and councils in England (49% and 57% respectively). Labour are second with 32% of councillors and 28% of councils controlled. 12% of councils have no overall control, the Liberal Democrats control 2% (8), and 1% (2) are controlled by 'other' parties.

The following table looks at council composition and control for all local authorities in England immediately following local elections by year (generally held on the first Thursday of May). As above, this includes those where elections were not held.

Council control by party immediately following local elections, England

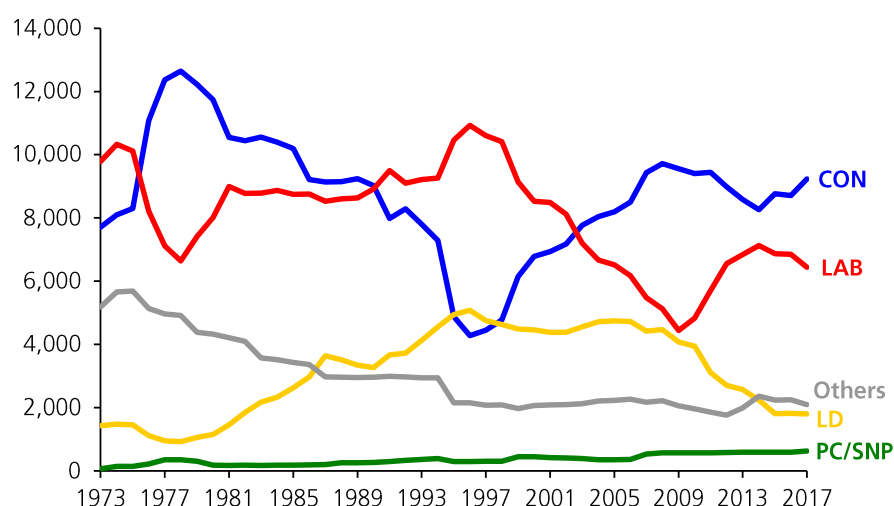
	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
All councils, England													
CON	155	168	204	213	207	199	199	190	180	164	192	191	200
LAB	71	54	48	44	33	50	77	100	103	106	100	100	99
LD	31	32	29	29	26	25	14	12	12	10	6	7	8
IND/OTH	7	5	5	5	4	4	1	1	1	1	2	1	2
NOC	122	127	100	95	81	73	60	48	55	70	51	52	42
Total	386	386	386	386	351	351	351	351	351	351	351	351	351
Percentages													
CON	40%	44%	53%	55%	59%	57%	57%	54%	51%	47%	55%	54%	57%
LAB	18%	14%	12%	11%	9%	14%	22%	28%	29%	30%	28%	28%	28%
LD	8%	8%	8%	8%	7%	7%	4%	3%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%
IND/OTH	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	1%	0%	1%
NOC	32%	33%	26%	25%	23%	21%	17%	14%	16%	20%	15%	15%	12%

Source: Rallings and Thrasher Local Elections Handbooks 2005 - 2016 & Local Government Chronicle's articles

There has been little change following the 2017 elections. **Labour** controls 99 councils, 1 fewer than in 2016. The **Conservatives** increased the number of councils they control by 9 to 200, their largest number of councils controlled since 2009. The **Liberal Democrats** control 8 councils, 1 more than in 2016, but this is still lower than any time in the decade before 2015. Their highest return in this period came in 2006 where they controlled 32 councils just 22 less than Labour at the time.

For the past few years the **Conservatives** have controlled approximately double the amount of councils than Labour (57% to 28%). Their best result in the past decade, however, was in 2009 when they controlled 59% of councils compared to **Labour's** 9%.

Party affiliation of councillors in Great Britain



Note: Liberal Democrats includes predecessor parties

Sources: Rallings and Thrasher, British Electoral Facts 1982-2006; Rallings and Thrasher, Local Elections handbook; Rallings and Thrasher, Local Government Chronicles

The chart above shows the number of councillors by party in Great Britain in 1973 to 2017. As of elections in May 2017, the Conservatives have 9,233 (46%) councillors in Great Britain, Labour 6,439 (32%), the Liberal Democrats 1,803 (9%) and Plaid Cymru and the Scottish National Party 634 (3%). There are a further 2,100 (10%) of councillors in Great Britain who are either independents or members of other parties.

8. Mayoral elections

There were mayoral elections in eight areas of England on 4 May 2017. Doncaster and North Tyneside held mayoral elections for their respective local authority and the first elections for six elected mayors of combined authorities (known as 'metro-mayors') took place.

Labour candidates won in both the local authority mayor elections. In **Doncaster**, Ros Jones was elected on the first round with 50.9% of first preference votes. In **North Tyneside**, Norma Redfearn was elected on the first round with 56.4% of first preference votes.

In the 'metro-mayor' elections the Conservatives won four of the contests and Labour won two (see the table on the following page). The mayoral election for the Sheffield city region has been postponed to May 2018.

Results of Council Mayor elections, 4 May 2017

		First preference		Second preference		Total vote	
	Turnout	Number	%	Number	%	Number	%
Doncaster							
George Jabbour		28.9%	13,575	21.2%		A candidate received more than 50% of the valid first preference votes and was therefore elected without second preference votes being counted.	
Ros Jones (Elected)		32,631	50.9%				
Brian Whitmore		7,764	12.1%				
Other candidates		10,110	15.8%				
Total		64,080					
<i>Electorate: 221,789</i>							
North Tyneside							
Stewart Hay		34.1%	16,164	30.7%		A candidate received more than 50% of the valid first preference votes and was therefore elected without second preference votes being counted.	
Norma Redfearn (Elected)		29,655	56.4%				
John Appleby		3,537	6.7%				
Stuart Houghton		3,248	6.2%				
Total		52,604					
<i>Electorate: 154,480</i>							

Source: Results published online by local authorities

Results of Metropolitan Mayor elections, 4 May 2017

		First preference		Second preference		Total vote		
	Turnout	Number	%	Number	%	Number	%	
Cambridgeshire and Peterborough	32.9%							
James Palmer (Elected)	CON	76,064	38.0%		12,762	38.7%	88,826	56.9%
Kevin Price	LAB	37,297	18.6%					
Rod Cantrill	LD	47,026	23.5%		20,179	61.3%	67,205	43.1%
Paul Bullen	UKIP	15,931	8.0%					
Julie Howell	GRN	12,628	6.3%					
Other candidates	Oth	11,432	5.7%					
Total		200,378						
Electorate: 608,808								
Greater Manchester	28.6%							
Sean Anstee	CON	128,752	22.7%					
Andy Burnham (Elected)	LAB	359,352	63.4%					
Jane Brophy	LD	34,334	6.1%					
Shneur Odze	UKIP	10,583	1.9%					
Will Patterson	GRN	13,424	2.4%					
Other candidates	Oth	20,290	3.6%					
Total		566,735						
Electorate: 1,982,343								
Liverpool City Region	25.9%							
Tony Caldeira	CON	58,805	20.4%					
Steve Rotheram (Elected)	LAB	171,167	59.3%					
Carl Cashman	LD	19,751	6.8%					
Paula Walters	UKIP	11,946	4.1%					
Tom Crone	GRN	14,094	4.9%					
Other candidates	Oth	12,897	4.5%					
Total		288,660						
Electorate: 1,116,495								
Tees Valley	21.0%							
Ben Houchen (Elected)	CON	40,278	39.4%		8,300	55.7%	48,578	51.1%
Sue Jeffrey	LAB	39,797	39.0%		6,603	44.3%	46,400	48.9%
Chris Foote Wood	LD	12,550	12.3%					
John Tennant	UKIP	9,475	9.3%					
Total		102,100						
Electorate: 486,964								
West Midlands	26.3%							
Andy Street (Elected)	CON	216,280	41.9%		22,348	47.6%	238,628	50.4%
Sion Simon	LAB	210,259	40.8%		24,603	52.4%	234,862	49.6%
Beverley Nielsen	LD	30,378	5.9%					
Pete Durnell	UKIP	29,051	5.6%					
James Burn	GRN	24,260	4.7%					
Other candidates	Oth	5,696	1.1%					
Total		515,924						
Electorate: 1,961,153								
West of England	29.3%							
Tim Bowles (Elected)	CON	53,796	27.3%		16,504	42.5%	70,300	51.6%
Lesley Mansell	LAB	43,627	22.2%		22,296	57.5%	65,923	48.4%
Stephen Williams	LD	39,794	20.2%					
Aaron Foot	UKIP	8,182	4.2%					
Darren Hall	GRN	22,054	11.2%					
Other candidates	Oth	29,500	15.0%					
Total		196,953						
Electorate: 671,280								

Source: Results published online by local authorities

9. About the data

There is no central database where local elections results are collected by an official body.

[Plymouth University Election Centre's](#) Colin Rallings and Michael Thrasher have compiled [Local Elections Handbooks](#) each year since 1985. Historic data quoted in this briefing paper is derived, in most cases, from these handbooks; 2017 figures for net change in seats and councils controlled are derived from Rallings and Thrasher's May 2017 articles in the [Sunday Times](#) and [Local Government Chronicle](#).

The House of Commons Library has collected 2017 data on the number of seats won or retained by party and resultant council control for those councils in which elections occurred. These have been cross-checked this data with that collected by the BBC and Press Association.

This briefing paper is therefore largely based on data collected by three sources: Plymouth University Election Centre, the House of Commons Library and selected media organisations.

Its findings may in some cases differ from analysis available elsewhere as a result of different definitions or reference points used.

Local elections results can be analysed by looking at either:

- A) The total number of councils controlled and councillors a party has at a given time; or
- B) The number of councils won/lost or seats won/lost at any given round of elections

It is not always possible to compare directly between data based on definitions 'A' and 'B' as they in effect monitor different things.

'A' looks at the total number of councils controlled or councillors by party *at a given time* – usually immediately following elections.

'B' looks at *net change*, comparing the number of councils or seats won/lost at an election to the situation immediately prior to that election.

A party's number of councillors and number of councils controlled are subject to change over the course of the year (councillors may change parties or by-elections occur, for example), meaning figures used to calculate net change at an election ('B') will not necessarily match with the totals monitored on an annual basis ('A').

Local Elections 2017: Results

		Council Composition (post May 2017 elections)							Share of seats (%)							Net seats compared to last round of elections						
		CON	LAB	LD	UKIP	GRN	OTH	TOTAL	CON	LAB	LD	UKIP	GRN	OTH		CON	LAB	LD	UKIP	GRN	OTH	
County Councils																						
	Buckinghamshire	41	1	4	0	0	3	49	84%	2%	8%	0%	0%	6%		+5	0	-1	-6	0		+2
B	Cambridgeshire	36	7	15	0	0	3	61	59%	11%	25%	0%	0%	5%		+4	0	+1	-12	0		-1
	Cumbria	37	26	16	0	0	5	84	44%	31%	19%	0%	0%	6%		+11	-9	0	0	0		-2
	Derbyshire	37	24	3	0	0	0	64	58%	38%	5%	0%	0%	0%		+19	-19	0	0	0		0
B	Devon	42	7	7	0	1	3	60	70%	12%	12%	0%	2%	5%		+4	0	-2	-4	0		0
B	Dorset	32	1	11	0	2	0	46	70%	2%	24%	0%	4%	0%		+5	-4	-1	-1	+2		0
	East Sussex	30	4	11	0	0	5	50	60%	8%	22%	0%	0%	10%		+10	-3	+1	-7	0		0
	Essex	56	6	7	0	1	5	75	75%	8%	9%	0%	1%	7%		+14	-3	-2	-9	-1		+1
B	Gloucestershire	31	5	14	0	2	1	53	58%	9%	26%	0%	4%	2%		+8	-4	0	-3	+1		-2
B	Hampshire	56	2	19	0	0	1	78	72%	3%	24%	0%	0%	1%		+11	-2	+2	-10	0		-1
B	Hertfordshire	51	9	18	0	0	0	78	65%	12%	23%	0%	0%	0%		+5	-6	+2	0	0		0
B	Kent	67	5	7	0	1	1	81	83%	6%	9%	0%	1%	1%		+22	-8	0	-17	0		0
B	Lancashire	46	30	4	1	1	2	84	55%	36%	5%	1%	1%	2%		+11	-9	-2	+1	0		-1
B	Leicestershire	36	6	13	0	0	0	55	65%	11%	24%	0%	0%	0%		+6	-4	0	-2	0		0
B	Lincolnshire	58	6	1	0	0	5	70	83%	9%	1%	0%	0%	7%		+22	-6	-2	-16	0		-5
	Norfolk	55	17	11	0	0	1	84	65%	20%	13%	0%	0%	1%		+15	+3	+1	-15	-4		0
	North Yorkshire	55	4	3	0	0	10	72	76%	6%	4%	0%	0%	14%		+10	-3	-5	-2	0		0
	Northamptonshire	43	12	2	0	0	0	57	75%	21%	4%	0%	0%	0%		+7	+1	-4	-3	0		-1
B	Nottinghamshire	31	23	1	0	0	11	66	47%	35%	2%	0%	0%	17%		+10	-11	-7	0	0		+7
	Oxfordshire	31	14	13	0	0	5	63	49%	22%	21%	0%	0%	8%		0	-1	+2	0	-2		+1
	Somerset	35	3	12	0	2	3	55	64%	5%	22%	0%	4%	5%		+6	0	-6	-3	+2		+1
	Staffordshire	51	10	0	0	0	1	62	82%	16%	0%	0%	0%	2%		+17	-14	0	-2	0		-1
	Suffolk	52	11	5	0	3	4	75	69%	15%	7%	0%	4%	5%		+13	-4	-2	-9	+1		+1
	Surrey	61	1	9	0	1	9	81	75%	1%	11%	0%	1%	11%		+3	0	0	-3	0		0
B	Warwickshire	36	10	7	0	2	2	57	63%	18%	12%	0%	4%	4%		+10	-12	-2	0	0		-1
B	West Sussex	56	5	9	0	0	0	70	80%	7%	13%	0%	0%	0%		+10	-1	+1	-10	0		-1
	Worcestershire	40	10	3	0	2	2	57	70%	18%	5%	0%	4%	4%		+10	-2	0	-4	0		-4
County Councils Total		1202	259	225	1	18	82	1,787	67%	14%	13%	0%	1%	5%		+268	-121	-26	-137	-1		-7
Unitary Authorities																						
	Cornwall	46	5	37	0	0	34	122	38%	4%	30%	0%	0%	28%		+15	-3	+1	-6	-1		-7
	County Durham	10	74	14	0	0	28	126	8%	59%	11%	0%	0%	22%		+6	-20	+5	0	0		+9
	Isle of Wight	25	1	2	0	1	11	40	63%	3%	5%	0%	3%	28%		+10	-1	+1	-2	+1		-9
	Northumberland	33	24	3	0	0	7	67	49%	36%	4%	0%	0%	10%		+12	-8	-8	0	0		+4
	Shropshire	49	8	12	0	1	4	74	66%	11%	16%	0%	1%	5%		+1	-1	0	0	+1		-1
	Wiltshire	68	3	20	0	0	7	98	69%	3%	20%	0%	0%	7%		+10	-1	-7	-1	0		-1
Unitary Authorities Total		231	115	88	0	2	91	527	44%	22%	17%	0%	0%	17%		+54	-34	-8	-9	+1		-5
Metropolitan Borough																						
	Doncaster	7	43	0	0	0	5	55	13%	78%	0%	0%	0%	9%		-1	+2	0	-2	0		+1
Metropolitan Borough Total		7	43	0	0	0	5	55	13%	78%	0%	0%	0%	9%		-1	+2	0	-2	0		+1

Local Elections 2017: Results

Council Composition (post May 2017 elections)							Share of seats (%)					Net seats compared to last round of elections				
	CON	LAB	LD	SNP	OTH	TOTAL	CON	LAB	LD	SNP	OTH	CON	LAB	LD	SNP	OTH
Scottish Councils																
B Aberdeen City	11	9	4	19	2	45	24%	20%	9%	42%	4%	+8	-8	-1	+4	-1
B Aberdeenshire	23	1	14	21	11	70	33%	1%	20%	30%	16%	+9	-1	+2	-7	-1
B Angus	8	0	2	9	9	28	29%	0%	7%	32%	32%	+4	-1	+1	-6	+1
Argyll and Bute	9	0	6	11	10	36	25%	0%	17%	31%	28%	+5	0	+2	-2	-5
Clackmannanshire	5	5	0	8	0	18	28%	28%	0%	44%	0%	+4	-3	0	0	-1
Na h-Eileanan Siar	1	0	0	7	23	31	3%	0%	0%	23%	74%	+1	-3	0	+1	+1
B Dumfries and Galloway	16	11	1	11	4	43	37%	26%	2%	26%	9%	+2	-4	0	+1	-3
Dundee City	3	9	2	14	1	29	10%	31%	7%	48%	3%	+2	-1	+1	-2	0
B East Ayrshire	6	9	0	14	3	32	19%	28%	0%	44%	9%	+4	-5	0	-1	+2
B East Dunbartonshire	6	2	6	7	1	22	27%	9%	27%	32%	5%	+4	-6	+3	-1	-2
B East Lothian	7	9	0	6	0	22	32%	41%	0%	27%	0%	+4	-1	0	-3	-1
B East Renfrewshire	7	4	0	5	2	18	39%	22%	0%	28%	11%	+1	-4	0	+1	0
B City of Edinburgh	18	12	6	19	8	63	29%	19%	10%	30%	13%	+7	-8	+3	+1	+2
B Falkirk	7	9	0	12	2	30	23%	30%	0%	40%	7%	+5	-5	0	-1	-1
B Fife	15	24	7	29	0	75	20%	32%	9%	39%	0%	+12	-11	-3	+3	-4
B Glasgow City	8	31	0	39	7	85	9%	36%	0%	46%	8%	+7	-13	-1	+12	+1
B Highland	10	3	10	22	29	74	14%	4%	14%	30%	39%	+10	-5	-5	0	-6
B Inverclyde	2	8	1	7	4	22	9%	36%	5%	32%	18%	+1	-2	-1	+1	+3
B Midlothian	5	7	0	6	0	18	28%	39%	0%	33%	0%	+5	-1	0	-2	-2
B Moray	8	1	0	9	8	26	31%	4%	0%	35%	31%	+5	-2	0	-1	-2
B North Ayrshire	7	11	0	11	4	33	21%	33%	0%	33%	12%	+6	0	0	-1	-2
B North Lanarkshire	10	32	0	33	2	77	13%	42%	0%	43%	3%	+10	-9	0	+7	-1
Orkney Islands	0	0	0	0	21	21	0%	0%	0%	0%	100%	0	0	0	0	0
B Perth and Kinross	17	1	4	15	3	40	43%	3%	10%	38%	8%	+7	-3	-1	-3	-1
B Renfrewshire	8	13	1	19	2	43	19%	30%	2%	44%	5%	+7	-9	0	+4	+1
Scottish Borders	15	0	2	9	8	34	44%	0%	6%	26%	24%	+5	0	-4	0	-1
Shetland Islands	0	0	0	1	21	22	0%	0%	0%	5%	95%	0	0	0	+1	-1
B South Ayrshire	12	5	0	9	2	28	43%	18%	0%	32%	7%	+2	-4	0	0	0
B South Lanarkshire	14	21	1	27	1	64	22%	33%	2%	42%	2%	+11	-12	0	-1	-1
B Stirling	9	4	0	9	1	23	39%	17%	0%	39%	4%	+5	-4	0	0	0
B West Dunbartonshire	2	8	0	10	2	22	9%	36%	0%	45%	9%	+2	-4	0	+4	-2
West Lothian	7	12	0	13	1	33	21%	36%	0%	39%	3%	+6	-4	0	-2	0
Scottish Councils Total	276	261	67	431	192	1,227	22%	21%	5%	35%	16%	+161	-133	-4	+7	-27

Local Elections 2017: Results

	Council Composition (post May 2017 elections)						Share of seats (%)						Net seats compared to last round of elections					
	CON	LAB	LD	PC	OTH	TOTAL	CON	LAB	LD	PC	OTH		CON	LAB	LD	PC	OTH	
Welsh Councils																		
Isle of Anglesey	0	2	1	14	13	30	0%	7%	3%	47%	43%		0	-1	0	+2	-1	
Blaenau Gwent	0	13	0	1	28	42	0%	31%	0%	2%	67%		0	-20	0	+1	+19	
Bridgend	11	26	1	3	13	54	20%	48%	2%	6%	24%		+10	-13	-2	+2	+3	
Caerphilly	0	50	0	18	5	73	0%	68%	0%	25%	7%		0	0	0	-2	+2	
Cardiff	20	40	11	3	1	75	27%	53%	15%	4%	1%		+13	-6	-5	+1	-3	
Carmarthenshire	0	22	0	36	16	74	0%	30%	0%	49%	22%		0	-1	0	+8	-7	
Ceredigion	0	1	8	20	13	42	0%	2%	19%	48%	31%		0	0	+1	+1	-2	
Conwy	16	8	4	10	21	59	27%	14%	7%	17%	36%		+3	-2	-1	-2	+2	
Denbighshire	16	13	1	9	8	47	34%	28%	2%	19%	17%		+7	-5	0	+2	-4	
Flintshire	6	34	5	0	25	70	9%	49%	7%	0%	36%		-2	+3	-2	-1	+2	
Gwynedd	0	1	1	41	32	75	0%	1%	1%	55%	43%		0	-3	-1	+4	0	
Merthyr Tydfil	0	14	0	0	16	30	0%	47%	0%	0%	53%		0	-9	0	0	+6	
Monmouthshire	25	10	3	0	5	43	58%	23%	7%	0%	12%		+6	-1	0	0	-5	
Neath Port Talbot	0	43	1	15	5	64	0%	67%	2%	23%	8%		0	-9	+1	+7	+1	
Newport	12	31	2	0	5	50	24%	62%	4%	0%	10%		+2	-6	+1	0	+3	
Pembrokeshire	11	7	1	6	35	60	18%	12%	2%	10%	58%		+8	-2	0	+1	-7	
Powys	19	7	13	2	31	72	26%	10%	18%	3%	43%		+9	+1	+4	+2	-17	
Rhondda Cynon Taf	4	47	1	18	5	75	5%	63%	1%	24%	7%		+3	-13	0	+9	+1	
Swansea	8	48	7	0	9	72	11%	67%	10%	0%	13%		+4	-1	-5	0	+2	
Torfaen	4	29	0	0	11	44	9%	66%	0%	0%	25%		0	0	0	-2	+2	
Vale of Glamorgan	23	14	0	4	6	47	49%	30%	0%	9%	13%		+12	-8	0	-2	-2	
Wrexham	9	12	2	3	26	52	17%	23%	4%	6%	50%		+4	-11	-2	+2	+7	
Welsh Councils Total	184	472	62	203	329	1,250	15%	38%	5%	16%	26%		+79	-107	-11	+33	+2	

Note: B indicates that boundary changes have taken place.

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